

Advancing Access in Housing Nationally:

Fact Sheet on Low-Income Housing Tax Credit (LIHTC) Accessibility Requirements

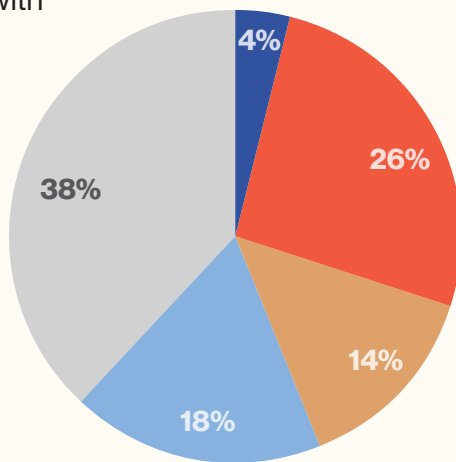
LIHTC, the nation's primary driver of affordable housing, does not have any in-unit requirements for mobility or sensory access, contributing to the severe shortage of accessible, affordable housing for people with disabilities. While 11.1% of people have serious difficulty walking or climbing stairs¹, less than 1% of the US housing stock is accessible to wheelchair users and less than 5% is accessible to people with mobility difficulties². For people with sensory and other disabilities, this shortage is equal or greater.

The shortage of affordable, accessible housing means disabled people and older adults, along with their families, experience higher rates of housing insecurity, homelessness, and institutionalization.

Section 504 of the Rehabilitation Act³ creates a uniform requirement of:

- 5% of the dwelling units be accessible for persons with mobility disabilities
- 2% of the dwelling units are accessible for persons with hearing or visual disabilities

States by (%) with requirements:



- Requires more than 504 (4%)
- Requires 504 (26%)
- Requirements less than 504 (14%)
- Incentives for accessible units (18%)
- No requirements (38%)

State-by-State Progress

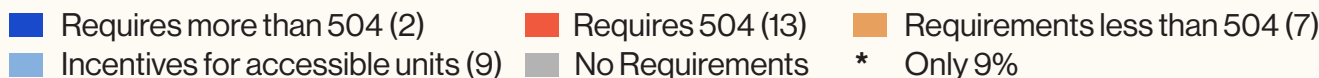
Many states are demonstrating leadership in accessible housing by already mandating or incentivizing access in their housing programs and funding in the following ways:

- A requirement for developments to follow Section 504
- A requirement for developments to build units beyond what Section 504 requires
- Other accessibility requirement less than what 504 requires
- Incentive structures where additional points are awarded for constructing accessible units

¹ Centers for Disease Control and Prevention, [Disability Impacts All of Us](#)

² U.S. Department of Housing and Urban Development Office of Policy Development and Research, [Accessibility of America's housing stock: Analysis of the 2011 American Housing Survey \(AHS\)](#).

³ Section 504 requirements are included in the Uniform Federal Accessibility Standards (UFAS)



The population of older adults and people with disabilities is rapidly growing. We cannot wait for all 50 states to implement individual standards. The federal government can ensure that no matter what state disabled people live in they have accessible housing by requiring that LIHTC follow the Uniform Federal Accessibility Standards (UFAS).

For more information on federal and state data and disability-forward LIHTC advocacy, contact hunter@thekelsey.org.

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